

Alex Berns

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Website: alexberns.github.io/berns
Citizenship: Germany

Experience

SB Intuitions (SoftBank Group), Tokyo, Japan

Research Intern, Responsible AI Team 2026
AI Safety research; conducted on Japan's largest GPU cluster

Feluwa Pumpen GmbH, Mürlenbach, Germany

Dual Study, Electrical Engineering (R&D) 2019–2024

Machine-learning model for fault diagnosis of double-hose membrane pumps

Mechatronics Technician (apprenticeship) 2019–2023

Switchgear, frequency converters & motors up to 1.2 MW; plant maintenance

Assembly of control panels & connection of sensor equipment

Trier University of Applied Sciences, Germany

Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate Mathematics 2021–2022

German–Chinese Society, Trier, Germany

Chinese Language & Cultural Assistant 2020–2023

Translation, interpreting & cultural exchange

Education

Tohoku University, Sendai, Japan

M.Sc. Computer Science 2024–2027

Advisor: Minoru Kuribayashi; Ito Foundation Full Scholarship (JPY 3.6M)

Also admitted to the Technical University of Munich (TUM)

Trier University of Applied Sciences, Germany

B.Eng. Electrical Engineering 2019–2024

GPA 3.4/4.0; thesis: ML for condition monitoring of membrane pumps

Berufsbildende Schule Wittlich, Germany

Certified Mechatronics Technician (IHK) 2019–2023

Recognized German dual-vocational qualification

Westlake Boys High School, New Zealand

Cambridge International A-Levels 2015–2019

A*A*A — Physics, German, Mathematics

Publications

Toxicity Lost in Translation: A Toxicity-Preserving Framework for LLM Safety Benchmarking

Berns, Huy, Pride, Wataoka — AAI 2027, Montréal, Canada

Layer-Wise Weight Statistics for Node Classification and Defense of Federated Large Language Models

Berns, Akai, Kuribayashi — APSIPA ASC 2025, Singapore

Selected Awards

FunkenSprüher Innovation Award for academic thesis — 750 EUR 2024

German National Chinese Language Competition — 2nd place 2023

AFS Exchange Scholarship (New Zealand Government) — six months with a 2018

Chinese host family, attending high school in Yantai, Shandong

Languages

German (native), English (native), Chinese (Mandarin, HSK 6), Japanese (JLPT N3)